

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 1276

By Crowe

A RESOLUTION to commend Randall Franks's *A Zippedy Doodle Day: American Folk Songs* for preserving Appalachian musical heritage and supporting Appalachian Music Scholarships.

WHEREAS, actor and fiddler Randall Franks, known around the world as "Officer Randy Goode" from television's *In the Heat of the Night*, is a descendant of several of East Tennessee's first families, with continuing roots, as his late Bruce grandparents' farm makes up the Head of Sequatchie portion of the Cumberland Trail State Park; and

WHEREAS, Randall Franks is a respected bluegrass and Americana artist, producer, and founder of the Share America Foundation, Inc., and is developing *A Zippedy Doodle Day: American Folk Songs*, a historic string band album and documentary that honors the rich legacy of folk artists John "Doodle" Thrower and the Golden River Grass, considered the last Georgia fiddle band of country music's string band era; and

WHEREAS, this effort preserves unreleased 1980s tracks while reintroducing their music to new generations through collaborations with stars of today; proceeds will benefit Appalachian music scholarships administered by the Share America Foundation, Inc.; and

WHEREAS, among the first Tennessee stars stepping forward to play a vital role in the project are Tim Atwood, Bruce Boxleitner, Gena Britt, Wyatt Ellis, Jimmy Fortune, Daniel Grindstaff, Jim Lauderdale, Kathy Lee, Alex Miller, Kody Norris, Mary Rachel Nalley-Norris, Ronnie and Justin Reno, Eb Saunders, Mike Scott, Margie Singleton, Larry Stephenson, Ketch Secor of the Old Crowe Medicine Show, Derek Stone, Leroy Troy, and Conner Vlietstra; and

WHEREAS, the project's recording engineers include Buck Jarrell, Jim Price, and Morgan Jahnig; additional artists from across the country who have contributed to the project

include The Skillet Lickers, Dom Flemons, Dante Flores, Trevor Holder, Dale Houston, Anthony Howell, Lee Newton, Paul Puckett, Alan Sibley, and Ralph Stanley II; and

WHEREAS, the Share America Foundation's Pearl and Floyd Franks Scholarship supports graduating seniors talented in traditional Southern and Appalachian music from several Tennessee counties, empowering young musicians to pursue higher education and carrying forward the State's rich musical heritage; and

WHEREAS, this initiative not only safeguards a unique chapter of American folk music history celebrated by historians such as Alan Lomax and Loyal Jones, it also fosters the next generation of Appalachian artists, strengthening cultural preservation and educational opportunities across Tennessee and the region; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we commend Randall Franks and *A Zippedy Doodle Day: American Folk Songs* for their outstanding contributions to Appalachian music preservation and scholarship support, and we express our gratitude to all Tennessee participants who have helped and will help advance this important project.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.